



The wooden lances used in this kind of tournament had blunted tips and were not meant to cause deadly harm.

The local nobles are devastated—their favorite knight has just taken a hit.

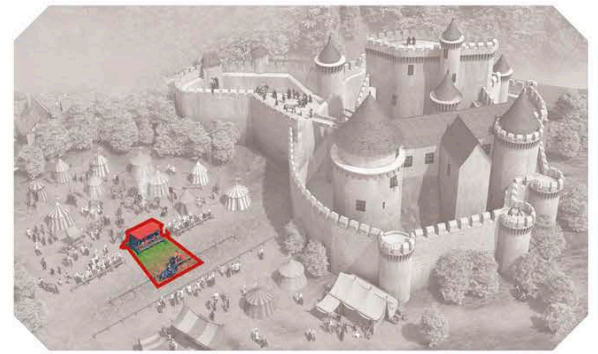
Peasants from the nearby village are allowed to watch the joust, but they are not welcome in the comfortable stand where the nobles sit.

This child is desperate to see the fighting up close—his favorite game is jousting knights.

A barrier fence called a tilt stops the two horses from charging straight into each other.

Each knight had his own family coat of arms. People would know who was who by looking at the coat of arms on the shield.

This horse wears the coat of arms and the red and gold colors of Bonaguil Castle—the knight riding him is the local favorite.



Playing at war

Medieval children were encouraged to play. They enjoyed many types of toys and games, including dolls, balls, stilts, swings, spinning tops, chess, dice, and little action figures such as this jousting knight.

COURTLY LOVE



Noble men and women enjoyed poetry about "courtly love." This was a romantic idea of courtship; the poems told of knights winning over their ladies with beautiful ballads or brave deeds. In reality, the marriages of nobles were arranged by their families.